

# Cricket in India

## Overview

Cricket is the most popular sport in India, played almost everywhere in the country and boasting one of the world's most successful national teams (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket_in_India)). The sport is governed by the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI), which manages domestic pathways, international selection, and a massive economic and political footprint amplified by the creation of the Indian Premier League (IPL).

## Key Findings

### Governance and Domestic Structures

The principal national governing body for the sport is the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI), established on 1 December 1928 under Act XXI of 1860 of Madras and subsequently re-registered under the Tamil Nadu Societies Registration Act, 1975 (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board\\_of\\_Control\\_for\\_Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board_of_Control_for_Cricket_in_India)). Headquartered at the Cricket Centre in Churchgate, Mumbai, the BCCI is a consortium of state cricket associations whose representatives elect the BCCI president (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board\\_of\\_Control\\_for\\_Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board_of_Control_for_Cricket_in_India)). The board oversees traditional Test cricket, institutionalizes domestic pathways through tournaments like the Ranji Trophy, and runs grassroots programs, coaching, infrastructure development, and player welfare programs (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board\\_of\\_Control\\_for\\_Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board_of_Control_for_Cricket_in_India)).

On the international stage, the BCCI is the wealthiest governing body of cricket in the world, with revenues exceeding ₹9,700 crore (\$1.0 billion) (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board\\_of\\_Control\\_for\\_Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Board_of_Control_for_Cricket_in_India)). A 2014 ICC structural overhaul led by the BCCI, Cricket Australia, and the ECB formed a new executive committee that overrode other ICC committees and granted immunity to permanent members based on revenue generation, cementing the BCCI's dominant global power.

### The Indian Premier League (IPL)

Founded in 2007 and initiated by the BCCI in 2008, the Indian Premier League is a professional Twenty20 (T20) cricket league featuring ten city-based franchise teams held annually between March and May (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian\\_Premier\\_League](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian_Premier_League)). The IPL is widely regarded as the world's most commercially successful cricket league and ranks as the 11th richest sporting league in the world by revenue (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian\\_Premier\\_League](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian_Premier_League)). It holds an exclusive window in the

International Cricket Council's Future Tours Programme, which results in fewer international tours occurring during its season (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian\\_Premier\\_League](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian_Premier_League)).

The league has evolved into a major economic juggernaut. Its estimated business value reached \$16.4 billion by 2024, contributing to a broader Indian cricket industry valued at \$5.3 billion. It broadcasts to over 180 countries and is the most viewed Indian sports event according to the Broadcast Audience Research Council (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian\\_Premier\\_League](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian_Premier_League)). In 2010, the IPL became the first sporting event to broadcast live on YouTube (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian\\_Premier\\_League](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indian_Premier_League)). According to BCCI data, the 2015 tournament alone contributed Rs 11.5 billion (\$182 million) to India's Gross Domestic Product, with an associated economic output of Rs 26.5 billion (\$418 million). The tournament drives wider economic activity by boosting tourism, increasing air travel and local accommodations, creating jobs, and facilitating major brand endorsements.

## **Team Success and International Play**

International cricket in India does not follow a consistent calendar pattern compared to Australian and English teams that tour during winters and play at home during summers (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket_in_India)). The India men's national cricket team has won 2 Cricket World Cups, 3 T20 World Cups, 3 Champions Trophies, and finished as runners-up twice in World Test Championships (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket_in_India)). The India women's national cricket team has won a Women's Cricket World Cup (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket_in_India)). Future major tournaments hosted by India include the 2026 Men's T20 World Cup, the 2029 Champions Trophy, and the 2031 Cricket World Cup (Source: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket\\_in\\_India](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket_in_India)).

## **Women's Cricket Growth and Structural Reforms**

Women's cricket in India originated in the 1970s through pioneers like Diana Edulji and Shantha Rangaswamy, who played without BCCI support, sponsorships, or proper recognition. Administrative integration began in 2006 when the Women's Cricket Association of India merged with the BCCI, though financial equity took much longer. A key structural reform arrived in October 2022 when the BCCI introduced equal match fees for men and women players. This institutional backing, alongside the launch of the Women's Premier League (WPL), has driven rising visibility, investment, and broader social transformation for the sport.

## **Sports Science, Analytics, and Machine Learning**

Indian cricket training increasingly integrates sports science, artificial intelligence, machine learning, and IoT technologies to optimize player performance and tactical

decisions. Professional teams utilize GPS tracking, video analytics, and biomechanical assessments to map performance, adjust strategies, and mitigate injury risks. Academic groups like the Center for Sports Science and Analytics at IIT Madras combine physics-based modeling, data-driven approaches, and sensor systems to modernize coaching frameworks, while specialized startups offer predictive performance tools and real-time metrics.

Complementing these practical applications, academic research has utilized machine learning to predict T20 match outcomes. One study analyzed a dataset of 5,390 international, domestic, and league T20 matches sourced from [espn.cricinfo.com](http://espn.cricinfo.com), surveying expert parameters from [espn.cricinfo.com](http://espn.cricinfo.com) and [cricmetric.com](http://cricmetric.com) alongside metrics such as "CurrentBattingPosition" and "AverageBattingPosition" (Source: <http://arxiv.org/abs/2209.06346v2>). The methodology evaluated player performance statistics, player ratings, performance-based player clustering, and ELO-based rating systems across machine learning algorithms like logistic regression, support vector machines, Bayes networks, decision trees, and random forest (Source: <http://arxiv.org/abs/2209.06346v2>).

## **Recent Developments**

The business value of the Indian Premier League reached an estimated \$16.4 billion by 2024. In October 2022, the BCCI instituted equal match fees for men and women players.

## **Points of Disagreement**

No significant contradictions were found across sources on this topic.

## **Conclusion**

Cricket in India operates as a deeply ingrained cultural phenomenon backed by the world's wealthiest governing body and anchored economically by the Indian Premier League. The sport combines traditional international success across men's and women's formats with modern advancements in sports science, data analytics, and structural equity reforms.